

Appendix — Sources, Assumptions, Formulas, Rejected Ideas

Project Sitara board pack · 28 July 2026 · All sources accessed 28 July 2026

A. Key verified facts (with sources)

AstroTalk FY25 revenue ₹1,182 Cr, profit ₹250 Cr, 80% repeat revenue, CAC ₹575–870 (Entrackr; bizfin.substack; growthx.club) · AstroSage AI: 80M downloads, AI astrologers rated 4.6 vs 4.3 human, ~90% margins (Business Standard/ANI) · AstroTalk international revenue +4.2x to ₹121 Cr (Entrackr) · Sri Mandir NRI ARPU ~ ₹7,000 vs ₹600–800 domestic; 20% of revenue international (TechCrunch) · Samarth eldercare ₹10,999–16,999/mo (care.samarth.community) · Diaspora 35.4M (India MEA) · Remittances \$129.4B 2024 (World Bank) · India affluent ~100M by 2027 (Goldman Sachs) · Recurly DTC churn benchmark ~6.5%/mo · Lensa –98% from \$30.75M peak month (Priori Data) · ElliQ 30–40 interactions/day sustained (NYSOFA/JARLIFE) · Imagen AI \$10M ARR profitable (TechCrunch) · Aftershoot 188K photographers (company-reported) · HoneyBook ~\$140M ARR (Sacra) · FamilyAlbum 30M users (MIXI) · Woebot shutdown 2025 (STAT News) · India Online Gaming Act 2025 (TechCrunch). Full URL list: research report Appendices A & B.

B. Model assumptions (all editable in Excel “Assumptions” sheet)

FX ₹90/\$ · GST 18% (India revenue modelled net; NRI zero-rated) · Blended net subscription ARPU ₹815/mo + add-ons ₹65 · churn 6.0%/mo base (7.5% cons / 4.5% aggr), glidepath to 5% floor from M13 · CAC ₹3,600 base (₹4,500/₹3,000) · referral 12% of new · refunds 2.5% · AI+infra ₹85/user/mo · human minutes ₹45 · support ₹25 · payment 2.8% · annual-plan share 60% · premium share 25% · founding 300 at M4 · funnel: visitor→trial 3%, trial→paid 25% (management estimates; replaced by Gate-1 cohorts).

C. Core formulas (as implemented in Excel)

Closing customers(m) = Opening + Marketing/CAC × (1+12% referral) + Founding – Opening × churn(m) · churn(m) = max(floor, base – 0.05pt × max(0, m–12)) · Avg subscribers = (Opening+Closing)/2 · Net revenue = Avg subs × (ARPU_sub + ARPU_addon) × (1 – refund) · COGS = Avg subs × (AI+human+support+infra) + gross revenue × 2.8% · Contribution/user = ARPU_total – variable costs = ₹678 · LTV = contribution ÷ churn = ₹11,306 · Payback = CAC ÷ contribution = 5.3 months · Cash(m) = Cash(m–1) + tranches + EBITDA(m) + Δdeferred (annual plans collect ~5.5 months ahead) – capex. All 2,044 formulas recalculate live (verified zero errors).

D. Rejected ideas and the evidence

Consumer AI photoshoots — Lensa: \$30.75M in Dec-2022, –92% within weeks, –98% by 18 months; free Gemini “Nano Banana” served India’s demand (16.6% of downloads, 1.5% of spend); child-image safety police-flagged (NCA, CyberPeace). **Celebrations/birthdays** — 1–3 events/family/yr; Evite ~\$26.5M after 25 years; Minted gives planning away free. **Kitty platforms** — PartyTambola killed by Online Gaming Act 2025; KittyParty.club negligible after

years. **Vastu** — zero consumer subscriptions exist anywhere; per-property pricing is revealed market wisdom (Livspace 94% one-time revenue). **Travel** — every scaled AI planner is free/affiliate (Layla, Mindtrip, GuideGeek); concierge economics are bank-funded B2B2C (Ten Lifestyle). **Standalone companionship** — the lonely person never pays (Khyaal ₹999/yr); payer channels fragile (Papa lost ~36 payers in one cycle); safety litigation active. **Personal-brand studio** — quarterly cadence; PhotoAI churn-volatile. **Life-story (Dhara)** — StoryWorth tiers end at book shipment; Artifact shut down 2025: gift-shaped, not subscription. **Broad family wellness** — HealthifyMe AI tier ₹208/mo price floor; Cult.fit ₹481 Cr FY25 loss at scale. **Weddings B2C** — 100% post-event churn; all winners monetise vendors/registry.

E. Data limitations

Private-company revenue figures are frequently third-party estimates (GetLatka/Growjo/StarterStory) or founder-reported; AI-headshot market sizes trace to vendor marketing; Reddit could not be crawled directly in phase 2 (pains corroborated via secondary sources); no census of Indian wedding photographers exists; conservative ends of ranges used throughout.